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How to query with NRQL: the mechanics of querying

Before using any tool, it's best to know how to use it. There's a process to creating, structuring, and writing queries with NRQL.

Understanding the rules of querying with NRQL enables you to get the most from your data. Even if you've never queried anything before, just a basic understanding the rules allows you to access (almost) any data you need and visualize them in [charts](#) and [dashboards](#).

Data exploration

One of the best ways to learn how to use NRQL is to access a New Relic [query tool](#) and use it to query your data. Here's an example of exploring your data using the [query builder](#) and the suggested entries from the interface.

TIP

Don't be afraid to play with your data! You won't break anything using any of our query interfaces, so feel free to tinker as much as you like!

The query begins with `FROM` followed by a space. The interface suggests available types of data, and you select `Transaction` from that list.



Next, choose an [attribute](#) using `SELECT` , and the query looks as follows:

On this page

Data exploration

NRQL query examples

Was this doc helpful?

Yes

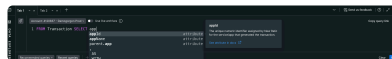
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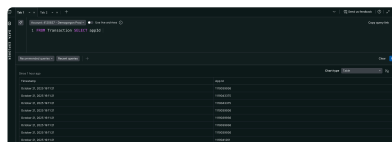
```
FROM Transaction SELECT
```

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Pressing space again causes the interface to suggest available attributes. In the example below, you choose `appId`.



This results in a very basic NRQL query using the required clause and statement (`FROM` and `SELECT`), and it provides a list of [APM](#) transactions and the associated `appId` for each, as shown below.



NRQL query examples

Here's an example of a slightly more in-depth NRQL query of

`Transaction` data reported by [APM](#).

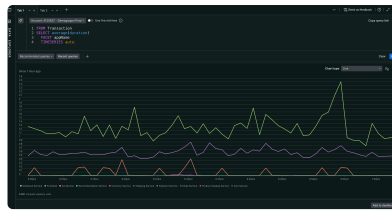
For this query:

- You choose `Transaction` as the data type.
- You use `select` to determine the average duration.
- You group results by `appName` using `Facet`.
- You use `Timeseries` to display the data over an automated timespan.

```
FROM Transaction
SELECT average(duration)
FACET appName
TIMESERIES auto
```

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This generates a chart that looks like:



Here are some more query examples:

Basic NRQL query of browser data

Attribute name with a space in it

Querying multiple data sources

Query returning multiple columns

IMPORTANT

To explore your data without having to use NRQL, use the [metrics and events data explorer](#). Learn more about [querying data in New Relic](#).

Ready to learn more? Be sure to check out our [introduction to NRQL](#) if you haven't already, or learn [how to use charts and dashboards with NRQL](#). If you want to start using NRQL right away, jump straight into our [guided NRQL tutorial](#).

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